

SHIPLAB

MASTER NORTH STAR • 2026+

Build a serious AI systems company that discovers real business problems, ships production AI systems, and turns repeated problems into products.

1. THE ONE SENTENCE

ShipLab is an AI Engineering & Systems Partner.

We design, build, deploy, and improve AI-native systems around how businesses actually work.

2. THE NORTH STAR

The long-term goal is not to become an AI receptionist agency, automation freelancer, or generic AI consultancy. The goal is to build a company with deep capability in turning messy, expensive business workflows into reliable production software powered by AI.

North Star: Business workflow → AI system → measurable outcome → reusable product/IP.

3. WHAT SHIPLAB SELLS

Our offer: We help companies identify high-value workflows where AI can create leverage, then own the journey from strategy to production.

- **Discover:** map workflows, bottlenecks, systems, data, constraints, and economics.
- **Design:** define the AI-native workflow, architecture, integrations, human-in-the-loop logic, and success metrics.
- **Prototype:** prove the solution against realistic workflows/data before overbuilding.
- **Build:** engineer agents, applications, automations, APIs, databases, interfaces, and integrations.
- **Deploy:** ship into the client's real environment with monitoring, fallbacks, security, and operational ownership.
- **Optimize:** measure results, improve reliability, and expand the system over time.

4. WHAT WE ARE NOT

- An AI receptionist company.
- An n8n automation shop.
- A chatbot/voice-agent agency.
- A generic software agency that says yes to everything.
- A consulting firm that produces strategy decks and leaves.
- A SaaS company before we have discovered a repeated problem worth productizing.

5. THE POSITIONING

Primary: AI Engineering & Systems Partner

Promise: We turn high-value business workflows into production AI systems.

Process: Discover → Design → Prototype → Build → Deploy → Optimize.

6. OUR DIFFERENTIATOR

Do not compete on the number of AI tools we know. Compete on our ability to understand a business, find the highest-leverage workflow, engineer the complete system, deploy it, and own the outcome.

We don't sell AI experiments. We ship systems that become part of the business.

7. TARGET MARKET STRATEGY

Start narrow enough to sell and learn. Grow broad only after proof. A first project can be lead recovery, customer support, document operations, sales operations, internal knowledge, or another high-value workflow. The first use case is a wedge—not the permanent identity of ShipLab.

Ideal customer signal: a growing company with a painful, repetitive, expensive, or slow workflow and enough budget to pay for a real production solution.

8. PRODUCT ENTREPRENEUR PATH

Services are the discovery engine. Products are the scale engine.

1. Solve a real problem for one company.
2. Repeat the solution across several companies.
3. Notice what stays the same.
4. Standardize the system and build reusable IP.
5. If the repeated problem has strong demand, turn it into software/SaaS.
6. Build a product company around validated demand—not guesses.

This means the founder journey is:

AI Engineering → Customers → Repeated Problems → Product → SaaS / IP

9. FIRST 90-DAY MISSION

- **Primary goal:** Get the first paying business project.
- **Then:** deliver it successfully and document the result.
- **Then:** repeat until a pattern appears.
- **Do not:** restart the strategy every time you see another AI company, SaaS idea, or tool.

10. DECISION FILTER

Before starting something new, ask:

“Does this directly improve ShipLab's ability to discover, sell, build, deploy, or productize AI systems for real businesses?”

If no → ignore it.

If yes → prioritize it.

11. BRAND LANGUAGE

Use	Avoid
AI systems	AI tools
AI engineering	AI automation only
Business workflows	Random automations
Production systems	Demos
Business outcomes	Cool AI
Discover → build → deploy	Just consulting
Product/IP from repeated problems	Build random SaaS

12. OFFICIAL SHORT BIOS

X: Founder @ShipLab • Building AI systems for real businesses • From workflow → production → product.

LinkedIn: Founder of ShipLab | AI Engineering & Systems | Building production AI systems around real business workflows.

Instagram: Building ShipLab ■■ AI systems for real businesses → products.

Website one-liner: ShipLab builds AI systems that turn high-value business workflows into production software.

13. WEBSITE STRUCTURE

- **Hero:** AI Engineering & Systems Partner.
- **Subheadline:** We turn high-value business workflows into production AI systems.
- **How we work:** Discover → Design → Prototype → Build → Deploy → Optimize.
- **Capabilities:** AI applications, agents, workflow systems, integrations, internal tools, data/knowledge systems, automation, and production infrastructure.
- **Industries:** Start with one or two sectors where you can develop real expertise; expand based on evidence.
- **Case studies:** Show the problem, old workflow, system built, deployment, and measurable result.
- **CTA:** “Discuss an AI System” or “Find Your Highest-Leverage Workflow.”

14. WHAT TO DO WITH THE AI RECEPTIONIST

Keep it. It is a portfolio asset and proof of engineering capability. Stop making it the category of ShipLab. It demonstrates voice AI, integrations, calendars, CRM, workflow orchestration, human handoff, and production thinking.

15. THE RULES

- Do not change the company direction because another founder's website looks better.
- Do not build a product without evidence of a repeated problem.
- Do not call yourself enterprise-grade before you can demonstrate enterprise-grade delivery.
- Do not confuse content, branding, or tools with business progress.
- Sell before overbuilding.
- Every project should teach you something that makes the next project faster or better.
- Build reusable IP whenever the same problem appears repeatedly.

16. THE NORTH STAR TO REMEMBER

ShipLab discovers important business problems, builds the AI systems that solve them, deploys those systems into real companies, and turns repeated solutions into products.

Everything else is secondary.